CLASS 8 — ENGLISH RUSKIN BOND · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 11: **The Child's Story** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. In the sentence 'the traveller lost them one day, as he had lost the rest of his friends', the repetition of loss builds: 1

(a) a mystery **(b)** a war scene
(c) a comedy **(d)** a pattern of passing time

2. The old man 'sitting on a fallen tree' could suggest: 1

(a) a life that has reached its rest **(b)** a joke
(c) laziness **(d)** a broken chair

3. Which word from the story is onomatopoeic? 1

(a) rumbling **(b)** forbearing **(c)** serene **(d)** solitary

4. The gentleman 'was not alone, but had a lady'. This marks a shift from the earlier stages because now: 1

(a) he travels alone **(b)** the journey is shared with a family
(c) he has no work **(d)** he has become young

5. 'Face to face with the serene sunset' conveys that the old man: 1

(a) is angry at the sunset **(b)** is blinded by the sun
(c) has lost his way **(d)** faces the end of life without fear

6. Read: 'to see how smooth and deep the drift was; and to listen to the hush upon the paths'. The word 'hush' creates a feeling of: 1

(a) anger **(b)** danger **(c)** noise **(d)** silence and calm

7. The 'long green avenue' that opens into deeper woods most likely symbolises: 1

(a) a road to the market
(b) paths that open for children to follow their own lives
(c) a river
(d) a school

8. Which statement about the ending is true? 1

(a) The friends physically return and stay
(b) The traveller finds his friends in memory and loves them all
(c) The old man disappears
(d) The traveller leaves the wood alone and angry

9. Which of these shows the author's use of simile? 1

(a) snowflakes like down from white birds **(b)** the child was always at play
(c) the wood was dark **(d)** the sun was so bright

10. Which statement best interprets 'the child who went to Heaven, rose into the golden air and vanished'? 1

(a) a child went to school **(b)** a child died young
(c) a child went to sea **(d)** a child flew in a balloon

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How does the setting change when the gentleman appears? 2

12. How does the story make death seem gentle? 2

13. Explain: 'He soon forgot a great deal of it.' 2

14. What does 'cutting down the trees' and 'carrying burdens' suggest about adult life? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Discuss the use of 'dark path' and 'sunset' as framing images. 3

16. How do the changing seasons of the wood reflect the characters' ages? 3

17. Use the homophones 'compliment' and 'complement' in sentences of your own. 3

OR

How does Dickens blend humour and emotion in the young man's story? 3

18. What does the traveller's loss of each friend teach us about change? 3

OR

Explain the difference between 'stationary' and 'stationery' with an example for each. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Critically examine the symbolism of the wood, the avenues and the sunset. 5

OR

Write a short summary of the story in not more than 100 words. 5

20. Analyse how the author makes the loss of the wife moving without using harsh words. 5

OR

Evaluate how effective the fable form is for Dickens's message. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks